Samuel Jalalian

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Affiliations	Department of Sociology, LMU Munich; Munich International Stone Center for Inequality Research (ISI)

Research Interests: Wealth inequality, sociology of education, educational policy, quantitative methods

Education

10/2023 – present	**Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität (LMU) München** PhD in Sociology, Chair of Social Structures and Social Inequalities (Prof. Dr. Fabian Pfeffer)
04/2021 – 09/2023	**University of Bamberg** Master of Arts (M. A.) in Sociology, with distinction (Grade: 1.1)
10/2017 – 04/2021	**Friedrich-Alexander-Universität (FAU) Erlangen-Nürnberg** Bachelor of Arts (B. A.) in Sociology and Philosophy (Joint Degree) (Grade: 1.3)

Selected Academic Positions & Industry Experience

10/2023 – present	**Ludwig-Maximilians-Universität (LMU) Munich** PhD Student, Chair of Social Structures and Social Inequalities (Prof. Dr. Fabian Pfeffer): research and teaching

01/2023 – 08/2023	**University of Bamberg** Student Research Assistant, Chair of Demography (Prof. Dr. Henriette Engelhardt-Wölfler): literature research and data analysis in Stata
03/2020 – 09/2022	**Friedrich-Alexander-Universität (FAU) Erlangen-Nürnberg** Student Research Assistant and Tutor, Chair of Empirical Social Research Methods (Prof. Dr. Nicole J. Saam): teaching in quantitative methods; qualitative data coding in MAXQDA; preparation of teaching materials and exam support
07/2022 – 08/2022, 08/2020 – 12/2020	**Academy of Fine Arts Nuremberg** Student Research Assistant: implementation and analysis of two internal university surveys (Unipark)
03/2019 – 02/2020	**Forschungswerk GmbH – Handfeste Marktforschung** Supervisor, market research
08/2018 – 01/2019	**infas – Institute for Applied Social Science** Interviewer, social science research studies

Science Communication and Media

06/2025 – 08/2026	Creation of two educational videos on wealth inequality and editing of four additional videos on social inequality for a BMBF-funded project, published on the open educational platform OPENvhb (2026). [Link forthcoming]
10/2020 – present	Creation of over 50 educational YouTube videos in philosophy, sociology, and related fields (YouTube Channel: @Samuel_Jalalian)
Media Coverage	TZ, Merkur, Psychologie Heute

Manuscripts in Progress

1. Ehlert, Martin; Pfeffer, Fabian T.; & **Jalalian, Samuel**. "Wealth as Private Insurance: Unequal Protection against the Scarring Effects of Unemployment in the U.S. and Germany." *(Under review; working paper available here)*

2. **Jalalian, Samuel**; & Pfeffer, Fabian T. "Another Empty Promise of Grade Retention: Peer Effects of Classmate Retention on Promoted Students."
(Under review; working paper available here)

3. **Jalalian, Samuel**. "Student Aid and Parental Wealth: A Blind Spot in the Pursuit of Equity?"
(In preparation)

4. **Jalalian, Samuel**; & Radau, Lena. "Institutional Drift in Capitalism: The Case of German Student Aid"
(In preparation)

5. Disslbacher, Franziska; Gottweis, Raphael; Hünewaldt, Victoria; **Jalalian, Samuel**; & Rösler, Daniel. "How Contextualizing Wealth Shapes Perceptions and Tax Preferences."
(In preparation)

Grants & Funding

2025: Kaiserschild Advance: Research Funding "How Contextualizing Wealth Shapes Perceptions and Tax Preferences" (€10,000; PI: Franziska Disslbacher; Co-PIs: **Samuel Jalalian**, Raphael Gottweis, Victoria Hünewaldt, Daniel Rösler)

Conference Presentations and Invited Talks

[c] = presented by a co-author | * invited | *forthcoming*

2026: * ISI Inequality Day (Munich)

2025: 10th International NEPS Conference (Bamberg)
ISI Wealth Conference 2025 (Munich)
Annual Conference of Experimental Sociology (Leipzig)
120th Annual Meeting of the American Sociological Association (Chicago) [c]
Inequalities and opportunities: Insights into wealth, income and education (Bari) [c]

2024: 9th International NEPS Conference (Bamberg)
ECSR 2024 Conference (Barcelona) [c]
* Economics of Intergenerational Mobility Conference (Chicago) [c]

Selected Workshops and Professional Development

Research (03/2025): Two-week Spring School on Perceptions of Wealth Inequality (SPINE), University of Bamberg; funded by the Volkswagen Foundation

Teaching (02/2024–present): Higher-education teaching workshops toward the *Zertifikat Hochschullehre der Bayerischen Universitäten*

Academic development (2024–2026): Professional development in academic presentation (Marcus John Henry Brown), voice training (Julia Rupprecht), and academic networking (Amanda Habbershaw)

Teaching

Term	Course	Format
Winter 2026/27	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Bachelor's Theses Seminar	B.A. seminar
Summer 2026	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Sociology of Wealth	B.A. seminar
	Reading Seminar: Limitarianism	B.A. reading seminar
Winter 2025/26	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminaR
	Lektürekurs: Die Teilhabegesellschaft	B.A. reading seminar
Summer 2025	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Bachelor's Theses Seminar	B.A. seminar
	Organisation of the ring lecture ("Ringübung")	B.A. lecture series (organizer)
Winter 2024/25	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Sociology of Wealth	B.A. seminar
Summer 2024	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Soziale Mobilität: Theorie, Methoden und empirische Befunde	B.A. seminar
	Vermögensforschung (with Fabian Pfeffer)	M.A. seminar
Winter 2023/24	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar
	Einführung in die Bildungssoziologie	B.A. seminar

Supervision

Bachelor's Thesis Supervision, BA, LMU Munich

15 theses supervised, 2024–2026

Peer Review

Sociology of Education (2), Research in Social Stratification and Mobility (2)

Academic Service

08/2025 – 04/2026	Coordination of a monthly informal lunch for PhD students at the Munich Graduate School of Sociology (MuGSS)
04/2024 – present	Deputy representative of mid-level academic staff on the Ethics Committee
10/2024 – 02/2025	Representative of mid-level academic staff on a faculty search committee at LMU Munich (Jülicher Model)

Languages

German (native), English (fluent), Italian (basic proficiency), Latin (comatose)

Software

Statistical Analysis: Stata

Digital Content Creation: DaVinci Resolve, Audacity, VideoScribe, GIMP

AI-Assisted Coding & Workflows: Claude Code, ChatGPT